

Solid Ground

Workbook belong to

The foundation for doing business solo

Welcome



Doing this alone is hard. I'm not going to lie.

There is no one to ask at 10pm when you can't figure out how to word something. No one to split the bills with while you work out whether this is actually going to work. No one to say "I think you should go for it" when you're three seconds away from talking yourself out of it AGAIN.

Because I've done it. Solo business is what I've had to figure out. Each time I have relaunched, or leapt or had to make a hard decision that impacts not only my business, but my life outside of that.

I started my first business in 2020. No one by my side or to have my back. No one around me who'd done it. No one who could tell me the how, what's and why's. It was a figure it out as you go and make the mistakes along the way. That's why this exists.

I built this guide for the experience nobody writes about. Starting a business when it's all on you. When the table is quiet and there's no one to run it past.

This workbook is built in pieces. Each module adds a page. You collect them as you go - not because the order is sacred, but because by the time you reach the end, you'll have something that's actually yours.

There's no perfect version of this. The messy notes, the crossed-out answers, the thing you wrote at midnight and second-guessed in the morning - that's the work. That's what makes it real.

Each section has been built with something you can actually do, not just read. This is not just a theory guide. There are also 3 bonus worksheets at the back that are yours to use however makes sense for your business and your life.

Start with one section. Start today.
You're already doing the hard part.

Jess x

Welcome

Before we start.

No need to be ready. No need to have it together. Just notice where you are.

SOMATIC CHECK-IN

What do you notice right now?

Close your eyes for a moment. Take a breath. Notice what's in your body - tension, excitement, heaviness, readiness. Whatever's there is allowed to be there.

REFLECTION

What brought you here? Write it without editing. No one is marking this.

INTENTION

What does Solid Ground look like for you? At the end of these modules - what's different?
What does it feel like to have it?

ONE THING

One thing you want to stop doing alone

The one rule: done beats perfect. Come back when you forget.

What you actually need

Your offer doesn't have to be perfect. It just has to be sayable.

DEFINE YOUR OFFER

Write your offer in 1 sentence. I help (who) to (what you help them with) through (the how you do it). It doesn't have to be elegant. Just get it out

I help _____

To _____

Through _____

THREE WAYS TO SAY IT

Write 2 different versions. One casual - Like you'd say to a friend; one simple - plain words, one sentence; one that feels most like you and what you offer.

Casual

Simple

Most like me

VOICE NOTE EXERCISE

Say your offer out loud. Record it. Listen back. What shifts when you actually hear it?

SOMATIC EXERCISE

Where does "this is real" land in your body? And where does doubt sit? You don't need to fix either. Just notice.

What you actually need

Your offer doesn't have to be perfect. It just has to be sayable.

REFLECTION

What would you need to be true for this offer to feel ready enough to say it to one person?

Tools that do the job

Free, functional, and nothing you don't need yet.

Tick each one off as it's done. Nothing Moves forward until this list is complete

- ☐ Professional email address set up - you don't need a personalised domain name
- ☐ Google/OneDrive folder for business files - a location you can source everything on the go
- ☐ ABN registered - abr.gov.au - free and takes 5 minutes and a MUST before your first invoice
- ☐ Canva - free tier available
- ☐ Live booking link - Halaxy, Squarespace, Calendly have free tiers
- ☐ Separate bank account open for business - there are free business options
- ☐ Payment method - PayID (sending invoices); Stripe, Paypal, Square charge a small fee
- ☐ Test payment system - sent and received - they're can be delays in arriving to the account
- ☐ Money Tracker - a manual tracker attached to this module, Xero. MYOB have free tiers
- ☐ Invoice templates saved and ready to use

REFLECTION

Which of these did you already have?

Which one felt the most uncomfortable to set up and why?

SOMATIC EXERCISE

Sit with this: "I have everything I need to start." Does it feel true? Where does it land in your body?

Brand Basics

How people feel when they find you. Let's make sure that's intentional.

BUSINESS NAME

Write every option you're considering. Include the one you keep coming back to even when you're not sure.

About each option: Can I say it easily out loud? Does it feel like me? Is it available (check ASIC: asic.gov.au)? Will it still fit in three years?

VOICE NOTE EXERCISE - FIND YOUR BRAND VOICE

Describe your business to a friend out loud. Not a pitch - a conversation.

Write down the words you naturally reached for. These are your brand words.

YOUR VISUAL STARTING POINT

2x colours, 1x font, 1 feeling. Enough to be and feel consistent. Not enough to be precious about.

Two Colours

Heading Font

Body Font

One feeling/word

REFLECTION

What does your brand feel like right now and what do you want it to feel like?

Right now

What I want

The gap

Getting Paid

Set it up like you believe you deserve to be paid. Because YOU DO!

WORK OUT YOUR STARTING PRICE

Service/Offer _____

Time taken (inc. prep + follow up) _____

What I'd need per hour to feel worth my time _____

My STARTING price _____

VOICE NOTE EXERCISE

Say your price out loud. Say it again. Say it a third time but like you mean it.

What shifted by the third time?

PAYMENT SETUP CHECKLIST

- ☐ Payment option live (PayID, Stripe, Paypal, Square)
- ☐ Test payment sent and received
- ☐ Invoice template ready - business name, ABN, date, description, amount, payment details
- ☐ I know when I send invoices - the day I deliver, every time, no exceptions

REFLECTION

Have you discounted before anyone asked? Where does this want or need come from? What does it bring up for you?

AN HONEST NOTE

The money might not come in straight away. That's not failure. That's building. Most businesses take longer than anyone admits, and doing it without a partner's income as a safety net makes that harder. You're allowed to know that and keep going anyway.

Your First Clients

They're closer than you think

THE THREE CIRCLES

Write as many names as you can in each circle. Don't over think it. Your first clients are most likely in circles 1 and 2.

CIRCLE 1 People you know	CIRCLE 2 People who know of you	CIRCLE 3 Strangers
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

FIRST OUTREACH PLAN

Pick people from circles 1 or 2. Write what you'll say and when.

PERSON 1 _____

What I'll say _____

When _____

PERSON 2 _____

What I'll say _____

When _____

PERSON 3 _____

What I'll say _____

When _____

Your First Clients

They're closer than you think

REFLECTION

What's the one thing you want to post or share but haven't? Write it here, just for you.

I'll Start When...

Name it. That's how it loses power.

NAME IT

Write out your specific "I'll start when..." Don't edit it. Whatever comes first.

CHECK IT

Is this a genuine gap - or avoidance? How do you know the difference?

EXPANSION PROMPTS

What would change if that thing were in place?

What am I really afraid will happen if I start now?

Is this fear of failing - or fear of what happens if it works?

Whose voice is the one saying "not yet"?

ONE STEP

What's one thing you could do this week that doesn't require that thing to be in place first?

Content + Showing Up

Consistently, in your voice, without it taking over.

CONTENT PILLARS

These are a theme that's always about your business. Something you could talk about every week. Think of it as a lane, not a single topic. "How I work" is a pillar. "Why I always start a session in silence" is something that falls into that pillar. Its recommended you have 3-4 pillars.

YOUR CONTENT PILLARS

3-4 themes that are always true for you and your business.

Pillar 1 _____

Pillar 2 _____

Pillar 3 _____

Pillar 4 _____

CONTENT IDEAS BANK

Fill this in now while you have momentum. Come back when you have nothing to post.
Something I know that my ideal client doesn't:

A question I get asked all the time

A mistake I made that's worth sharing

Something that happend this week that worth talking about

EXPANSION PROMPTS

What do I want people to feel when they find me online?

Content + Showing Up

Consistently, in your voice, without it taking over.

EXPANSION PROMPTS - CONT.

What am I afraid to say? (That one's usually worth saying)

What's the one thing I keep wanting to post but talk myself out of?

AI in Business

You don't have to figure out everything at alone.

You don't have to use AI. Like anything in business, it's a free resource, not a requirement or necessity. This section is here if it's something your interested in or is useful to you.

BEFORE YOU READ ANYTHING

What do you think AI can support you within your business? Don't look anything up, just write what comes to mind

What do you think you would use it for?

What would you like to keep doing yourself? And why does this matter?

A free reference guide with starter prompts is included with this module as a separate resource

WRITE YOUR FIRST PROMPT

Pick on task from your list above. Write a prompt you could use right now in an AI platform

Task

Prompt

AI in Business

You don't have to figure out everything at alone.

AI AS A SOUNDING BOARD

Write 1 question or decision you've been sitting with. Take it to AI. What came back?

Question

What came back that was useful

What I still need to sit with myself

EXPANSION PROMPT

What would it feel like to not have to figure everything out alone?

Energetics of Running Solo

Nobody talke about this part. Let's talk about it.

ENERGY CHECK IN

Before we go further, let's take a breath and check in.

What's your energy like right now? What's contributing to it?

YOUR DEPLETION SIGNALS

When you're heading toward empty, what happens first?

What's the early warning sign you tend to ignore until it's too late?

WHERE VISIBILITY RESISTANCE LIVES

Think about showing up online. Posting, telling people what you do, saying it out loud.

Where does the resistance land in your body?

What's underneath that resistance? (It's not always fear of failure. Often it's something else)

YOUR WORKING RHYTHM

What does you current working week look like? Not what you planned, what actually happens.

Energetics of Running Solo

Nobody talke about this part. Let's talk about it.

YOUR WORKING RHYTHM

What does you current working week look like? Not what you planned, what actually happens.

YOUR ANCHOR POINTS

If you had 2-3 fixed things in your week that never moved, what would they be? Not a full schedule, just enough structure to know where to put yourself.

EXPANSION PROMPTS

What time of day am I actually at my best? Am I working then, or fighting myself?

Where in my week do I consistently run out of energy? What happens leading up to that?

What does visibility fear feel like in my body? What does it want me to know?

What is one task or activity, if I held it every week, would make everything else more stable?
Like an anchor point.

Email List Building

Something you own. Something the algorithm can't touch.

YOUR FREEBIE CONCEPT

The problem it solves/information it shares:

The format - checklist/guide/audio/template:

What I'll call it:

STAGE 1 - BEFORE A PLATFORM

Start Here. No sign-ups or money required

- ☐ Spreadsheet created - name, email, date added, how they found me
- ☐ First contact added
- ☐ Sending method confirmed - Email BCC works up to 50 people

STAGE 2 - WHEN YOU'RE READY FOR A PLATFORM

Switch when your list hits 500-100, or when you want the welcome email to go out automatically

- ☐ MailerLite free account created (handles up to 1,000 subscribers for free)
- ☐ List imported
- ☐ Welcome email written and set to send automatically
- ☐ Sign-up form live

Email List Building

Something you own. Something the algorithm can't touch.

DRAFT YOUR WELCOME EMAIL

Subject line _____

Opening - something warm, like talking to a friend

What they can expect from you and the purpose of your emails

One thing you want them to know right now

Soft close

EMAIL TOPICS

Don't overthink it. What do you already know that would be helpful to your email list?

Pricing for Growth

Your starting price got you here. Here's where it goes next.

PRICING REVIEW

Current offer _____

Current Price _____

Hours it takes (all aspects) _____

Effective hourly rate _____

Does it feel sustainable? YES NO NOT SURE

SIGNS IT MIGHT BE TIME TO RAISE PRICES

- ☐ my books are consistently full
- ☐ I'm getting regulat enquiries I can't take on
- ☐ I've said yes to clients I'd rather not work with because I needed the money
- ☐ I haven't raised my prices in over 12 months
- ☐ People rarely question my price - could mean you're undercharging

EXPANSION PROMPTS

What would I charge if I trusted that people would pay it?

What's the gap between that number and my current price?

What's in that gap?

Pricing for Growth

Your starting price got you here. Here's where it goes next.

PACKAGE THINKING

Package name _____

Whats included _____

Length/# of sessions _____

Price _____

SOMATIC

Where does “charging more” land in your body right now? Just notice. What does it want you to know?

Making Decisions Alone

You know more than you think

BRING A REAL DECISION

What's a decision you're sitting with right now?

SOMATIC FIRST

Before your brain has an opinion, what does your gut sense?

EXPANSION PROMPT

Am I looking for permission or for information? Be honest.

If you trusted yourself completely, what would you do?

VISUALISATION

Six months from now, having made this decision. For each outcome, write down how each version of you feels

VERSION A

Making Decisions Alone

You know more than you think

VERSION B

VERSION C

Which version felt like you?

ONE STEP

What's one decision you've been putting off that you could make this week?

Legal + Tax Basics

Work through at your own pace. Everything in one place.

MODULE NOTE

This is an overview and practical starting point - not legal or financial advice. One accountant appointment early on is worth more than it will cost. The full slides are available as a download in this module

SETUP CHECKLIST

- ☐ ABN registered and confirmed (abr.gov.au - 5 minutes and free)
- ☐ Business name registered through ASIC - trading under a name other than your legal name
- ☐ Invoice template saved - business name, ABN, date, description, amount, payment details
- ☐ Business money tracker set up (resource attached to this module)
- ☐ Folder system in place (income records, expenses, receipts all in one place)
- ☐ Accountant booked - if found
- ☐ Privacy, refund and terms & conditions policies
- ☐ Professional indemnity insurance in place
- ☐ Public liability insurance in place - a must for those seeing clients in person
- ☐ Income protection insurance considered (sole traders have no sick leave)

TERMS, PRIVACY, POLICIES

Terms + Conditions

What you offer, how you deliver it, cancellation rules, what's clients agree to when they book or pay. Protects you if there's a dispute. termsfeed.com has a free generator or see attached general T+C's document

Privacy Policy

Required if you collect names and email - which you are, from day one. Goes in your website foot and on any opt-in form. privacypolicygenerator.info - 5 minutes, free, Australian options available or see attached general Privacy Policy

Refund policy

Especially important for digital products and 1:1 services. Be clear upfront - "no refunds after session begins" is fine as long as it's stated. Stripe and Paypal both have a field for your T=C's URL on payment links.

Legal + Tax Basics

Work through at your own pace. Everything in one place.

TERMS, PRIVACY + POLICIES

Do you have these? Where do they need to go?

Note what's in place and what needs doing

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR ACCOUNTANT

What would you ask an accountant if you have one appointment this week?

Write the questions now and use them when you book.

Closing

Look at what you've built

You went further than most people do.

NAME WHAT YOU HAVE NOW

Go through each module and write on thing you have now that you didn't have before.

MODULE 1 _____

MODULE 2 _____

MODULE 3 _____

MODULE 4 _____

MODULE 5 _____

MODULE 6 _____

MODULE 7 _____

MODULE 8 _____

MODULE 9 _____

MODULE 10 _____

MODULE 11 _____

MODULE 12 _____

REFLECTION

what surprised you the most about this process?

NEXT 7 DAYS

What's the one thing you're going to do in the next 7 days?

*You don't need to have it all
figured out.*

You just need to begin.



What's Next..

Keep going

You've built some real. Keep moving forward with what you're building.

Align + Flow

When you need a thinking partner - for decisions, momentum, or planning something out. 1:1 sessions with Jess shape around what you need.

energywithjess.com.au/booking

Soul-Led Business Pack

You've built the foundation. Now grow it. For women ready to take what they have and build something bigger

energywithjess.com.au/booking

Come find me on Instagram, Facebook & Tiktok

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